

ELECENG 3EY4
Sample Problems on Coordinate Frames and Homogenous Transformations

- 1- Consider the following chain of rotations

$$R_4^0 = R_y(\theta_1)R_z(\theta_2)R_y(\theta_3)R_x(\theta_4).$$

Express various ways of interpreting the rotations, about fixed and current axes that would yield the same result.

- 2- Find the ZYZ Euler representation for the following rotation matrix

$$R = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & \frac{-1}{\sqrt{2}} \\ 0 & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & \frac{-1}{\sqrt{2}} \\ -1 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

- 3- Consider the figure below. A robot is set up 1 meter from a table, two of whose legs are on the y axis as shown. The table top is 1 meter high and 1 meter square. A frame $o_1 - x_1y_1z_1$ is fixed to the edge of the table as shown. A cube measuring 20 cm on a side is placed in the center of the table with frame $o_2 - x_2y_2z_2$ established at the center of the cube as shown. A camera is situated directly above the center of the block 2 m above the tabletop with frame $o_3 - x_3y_3z_3$ attached as shown. Find the homogeneous transformations relating each of these frames to the base frame $o_0 - x_0y_0z_0$. Find the homogeneous transformation relating the camera to the object frame.

Now suppose that, after the camera is calibrated, it is rotated 90° about the axis z. Re-compute the above coordinate transformations.

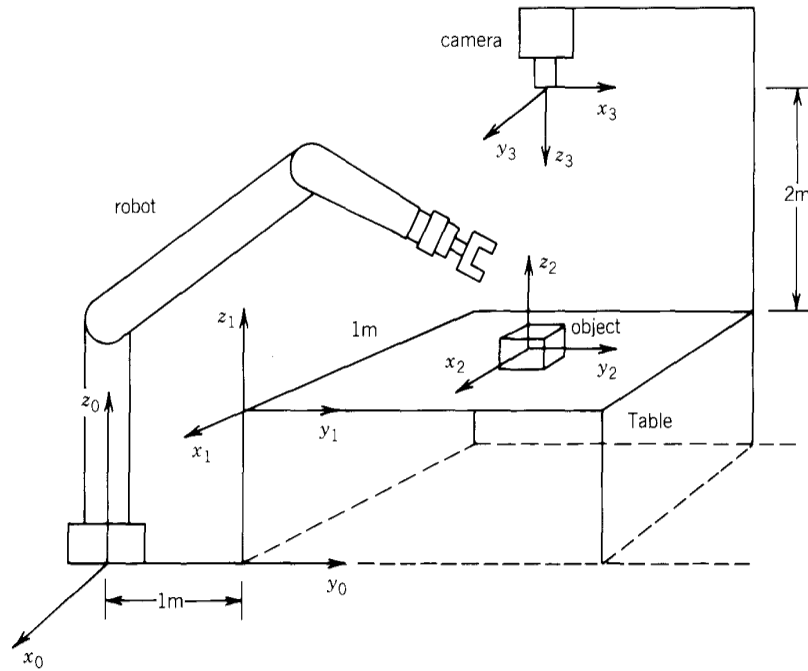


Fig. 1 (adopted from M. Spong and M. Vidyasagar, Robot Dynamics and Control, John Wiley & Sons)

- 4- In general, multiplication of homogeneous transformation matrices is not commutative. Consider the matrix product:

$$T = \text{Rot}_{x,\alpha} \text{Tran}_{x,b} \text{Tran}_{z,d} \text{Rot}_{z,\theta}$$

Here Rot and Tran are purely rotational and translational homogeneous transformations. Determine which pairs of the four matrices on the right-hand side commute. Explain why the pairs commute. Find all permutations of these four matrices that would yield the same homogeneous transformation matrix, T .

- 5- Consider the wedge-shaped object in Fig. 2. In this figure, Frame A and Frame B are attached to the rigid object whereas Frame 0 is a stationary reference frame. (Note that frames 0 & A initially coincide)

- a. Find the homogeneous transformation T_B^0 that relates Frame B to Frame 0 (0 is origin and B is destination).

- b. The coordinates of point **P** in Frame B are given by $P^B = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix}^T$. Find the coordinates of this point in Frame 0, P^0 .
- c. Assume that the wedge-shaped object is moved first by translating Frame A along its x-axis by -1 units and then rotating this frame about its current y-axis by $\frac{\pi}{2}$ radians. Calculate the new coordinates of point P in Frame B, $\bar{P}^B$. (Note that point P is *not* attached to the rigid object and therefore has *not* moved itself).
- d. Assume that the movement of the object is restricted to pivoting around the origin of Frame A, i.e., the origin of the frame *cannot* move. Find a rotation for Frame A that would bring the origin of Frame B to its closest possible distance from point P. Does this problem have a unique solution? Explain.

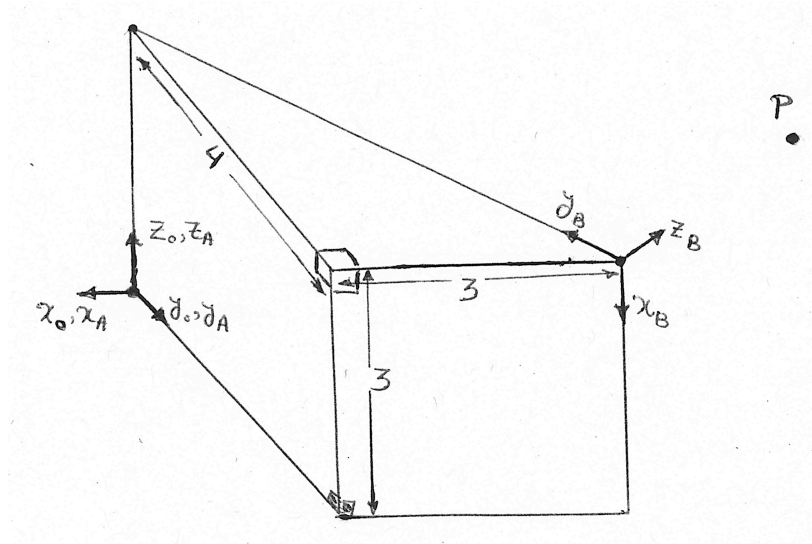


Fig. 2. The wedge-shaped object in Q5.

1)

- Rotations about current axes (Left to right)
- Rotations about fixed axes (right to left)

$$- \xrightarrow[\text{fixed } z]{\theta_3} R_z(\theta_3) \xrightarrow[\text{current } x]{\theta_4} R_z(\theta_3) R_x(\theta_4) \xrightarrow[\text{fixed } z]{\theta_2} R_z(\theta_2) R_z(\theta_3) R_x(\theta_4) \xrightarrow[\text{fixed } z]{\theta_1} R_z^0$$

$$- \xrightarrow[\text{current } z]{\theta_3} R_z(\theta_3) \xrightarrow[\text{fixed } z]{\theta_2} R_z(\theta_2) R_z(\theta_3) \xrightarrow[\text{fixed } z]{\theta_1} R_z(\theta_1) R_z(\theta_2) R_z(\theta_3) \xrightarrow[\text{current } x]{\theta_4} R_z^0$$

Other combinations can similarly be obtained.

2)

(i) $0 < \nu < \pi$ ($\sin \nu > 0$)

$$\varphi = \text{atan2}(r_{23}, r_{13}) = -3\pi/4$$

$$\psi = \text{atan2}(r_{32}, -r_{31}) = 0$$

$$\nu = \text{atan2}(\sqrt{r_{13}^2 + r_{23}^2}, r_{33}) = \pi/2$$

(ii) $-\pi < \nu < 0$ ($\sin \nu < 0$)

$$\varphi = \text{atan2}(-r_{23}, -r_{13}) = \pi/4$$

$$\psi = \text{atan2}(-r_{32}, r_{31}) = \pi$$

$$\nu = \text{atan2}(-\sqrt{r_{13}^2 + r_{23}^2}, r_{33}) = -\pi/2$$

Spatial Description of a Rigid Body

ZYZ Euler Angles $\Phi = \begin{bmatrix} \varphi & \vartheta & \psi \end{bmatrix}^T$:

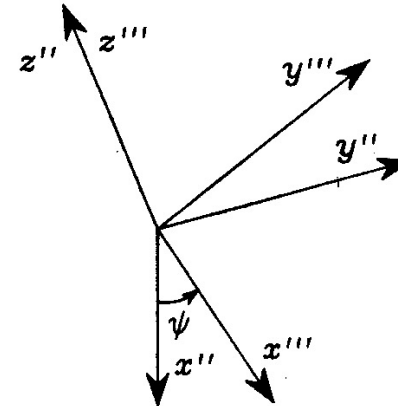
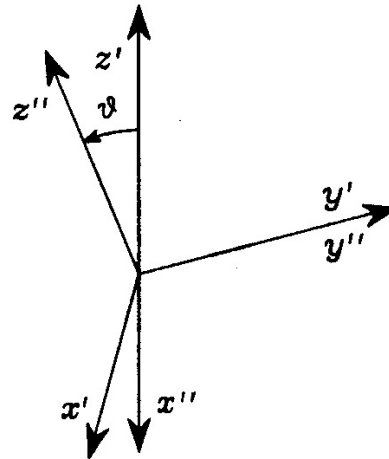
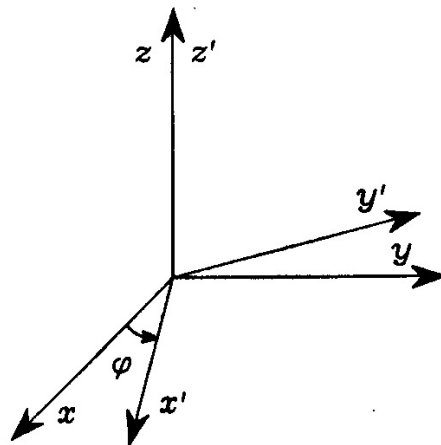
$R_z(\varphi)$: Rotation about $\underline{z}$ axis by the angle φ

$R_{y'}(\vartheta)$: Rotation about the current $\underline{y}'$ axis by the angle ϑ

$R_{z''}(\psi)$: Rotation about the current $\underline{z}''$ axis by the angle ψ

Equivalent
rotation matrix

$$R(\phi) = R_z(\varphi)R_{y'}(\vartheta)R_{z''}(\psi) = \begin{bmatrix} c_\varphi c_\vartheta c_\psi - s_\varphi s_\psi & -c_\varphi c_\vartheta s_\psi - s_\varphi c_\psi & c_\varphi s_\vartheta \\ s_\varphi c_\vartheta c_\psi + c_\varphi s_\psi & -s_\varphi c_\vartheta s_\psi + c_\varphi c_\psi & s_\varphi s_\vartheta \\ -s_\vartheta c_\psi & s_\vartheta s_\psi & c_\vartheta \end{bmatrix}$$



Spatial Description of a Rigid Body

ZYZ Euler Angles $\Phi = \begin{bmatrix} \varphi & \vartheta & \psi \end{bmatrix}^T$

Reverse procedure: Given the rotation matrix

$$R(\Phi) = \begin{bmatrix} c_\varphi c_\vartheta c_\psi - s_\varphi s_\psi & -c_\varphi c_\vartheta s_\psi - s_\varphi c_\psi & c_\varphi s_\vartheta \\ s_\varphi c_\vartheta c_\psi + c_\varphi s_\psi & -s_\varphi c_\vartheta s_\psi + c_\varphi c_\psi & s_\varphi s_\vartheta \\ -s_\vartheta c_\psi & s_\vartheta s_\psi & c_\vartheta \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} r_{11} & r_{12} & r_{13} \\ r_{21} & r_{22} & r_{23} \\ r_{31} & r_{32} & r_{33} \end{bmatrix}$$

What are the possible sets of ZYZ Euler angles?

$$\varphi = \text{Atan2}(r_{23}, r_{13})$$

$$\vartheta = \text{Atan2}\left(\sqrt{r_{13}^2 + r_{23}^2}, r_{33}\right)$$

$$\psi = \text{Atan2}(r_{32}, -r_{31}).$$

$$0 < \vartheta < 180$$

$$\varphi = \text{Atan2}(-r_{23}, -r_{13})$$

$$\vartheta = \text{Atan2}\left(-\sqrt{r_{13}^2 + r_{23}^2}, r_{33}\right)$$

$$\psi = \text{Atan2}(-r_{32}, r_{31}).$$

$$-180 < \vartheta < 0$$

Special case: when $\vartheta = 0$ or $180 \Rightarrow \sin(\vartheta) = 0$ and

$r_{13} = r_{23} = r_{31} = r_{32} = 0$. In this case, we have two consecutive rotations about two parallel axes and only φ or ψ can be found.

3)



$$A_1^0 = \left[\begin{array}{c|c} I & \begin{matrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{matrix} \\ \hline 0^T & 1 \end{array} \right]$$

$$A_2^0 = \left[\begin{array}{c|c} I & \begin{matrix} -0.5 \\ 1.5 \\ 1.1 \end{matrix} \\ \hline 0^T & 1 \end{array} \right]$$

$$A_3^0 = \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 0 & 1 & 0 & -0.5 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & 1.5 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 & 3 \\ \hline 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right]$$

$$A_2^3 = \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 & 1.9 \\ \hline 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right]$$

After camera rotation! (about z_3)

$$A_3^0 = \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 0 & 0 & -0.5 \\ 0 & -1 & 0 & 1.5 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 & 3 \\ \hline 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right]$$

$$A_2^3 = \left[\begin{array}{ccc|c} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 & 1.9 \\ \hline 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right]$$

4)



$$T_B^A = T_B^0 = \left[\begin{array}{cc|c} 0 & 3/5 & -3 \\ 0 & -4/5 & 4 \\ -1 & 0 & 3 \\ \hline 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right] \quad z_B = x_B \times y_B$$

$$b - \begin{bmatrix} p^0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = T_B^0 \begin{bmatrix} p^B \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$c - T_{B'}^0 = \left[\begin{array}{c|c} R_f(\pi/2) & \begin{matrix} -1 \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{matrix} \\ \hline 0 & 1 \end{array} \right] \quad T_B^A$$

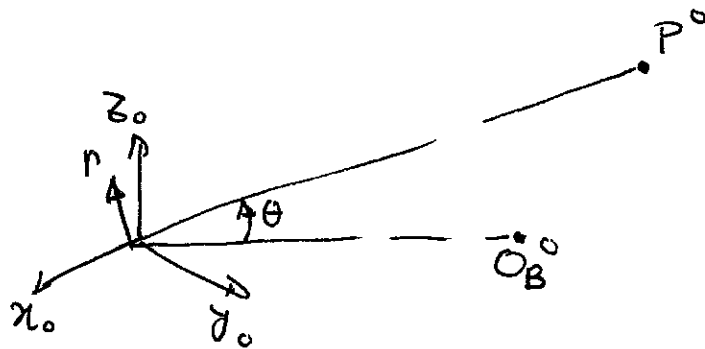
From part (a)



From part (b)

$$\begin{bmatrix} \bar{P}_B \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = T_{O}^{B'} \begin{bmatrix} \check{P}^0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

d -



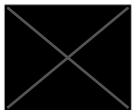
$$r = \frac{O_B^0 \times P^0}{\|O_B^0 \times P^0\|}$$

$$\theta = \cos^{-1} \left(\frac{P^0 \cdot O_B^0}{\|P^0\| \|O_B^0\|} \right)$$

$$R_A^0 = R \left(\vartheta, \frac{P^0}{\|P^0\|} \right) R(\theta, r)$$

any ϑ would $\Rightarrow$ an infinite number of solutions exist.

5)



$$T = \text{Tran}_{x,b} \text{Rot}_{x,\alpha} \text{Tran}_{z,d} \text{Rot}_{z,\theta}$$

$$T = \text{Tran}_{x,b} \text{Rot}_{x,\alpha} \text{Rot}_{z,\theta} \text{Tran}_{z,d}$$

$$T = \text{Rot}_{x,\alpha} \text{Tran}_{x,b} \text{Rot}_{z,\theta} \text{Tran}_{z,d}$$

$$T = \text{Rot}_{x,\alpha} \text{Tran}_{z,d} \text{Tran}_{x,b} \text{Rot}_{z,\theta}$$